Future Market: This is where the transactions are credit transactions. There is a promise to pay the consideration sometime in the future.

IV. On the Basis of Regulation

Regulated Market: In such a market there is some oversight by appropriate government authorities. This is to ensure there are no unfair trade practices in the market. Such markets may refer to a product or even a group of products. For example, the stock market is a highly regulated market.

Unregulated Market: This is an absolutely free market. There is no oversight or regulation, the market forces decide everything. Example:

V. On the basis of nature of competition

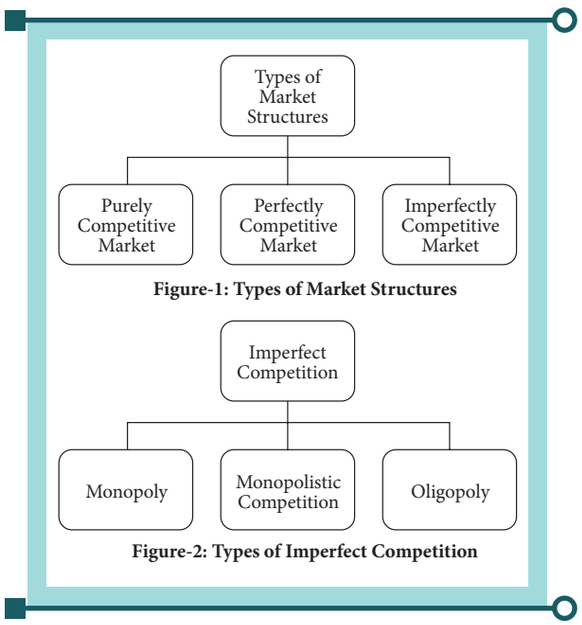


Figure-1: Types of Market Structures

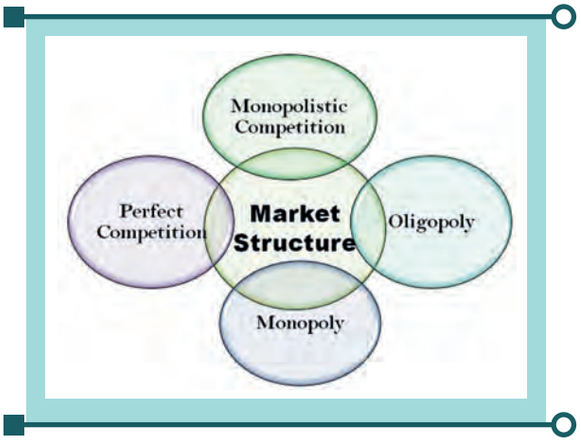
Figure-2: Types of Imperfect Competition

Monopoly:

Monopoly refers to a market structure in which there is a single producer or seller that has a control on the entire market. This single seller deals in the products that have no close substitutes.

Monopolistic Competition:

The term monopolistic competition was given by Prof Edward H. Chamberlin of Harvard University in 1933 in his book Theory of Monopolistic Competition. The term monopolistic competition represents the combination of monopoly and perfect competition. Monopolistic competition refers to a market situation in which there are a large number of buyers and sellers of products. However, the product of each seller is different in one aspect or the other.



Oligopoly:

The term oligopoly has been derived from two Greek words, Oligoi means few and poly means control. Therefore, oligopoly refers to a market form in which there are few sellers dealing either in homogenous or differentiated products.

1. Who is a Consumer?

A Consumer is a person who purchases a product or avails a service for a consideration, either for his personal use or to earn his livelihood by means of self employment.

The consideration may be:

- ✓ Paid
- ✓ Promised
- ✓ Partly paid and partly promised.

It also includes a beneficiary of such goods/services when such use is made with the approval of such person.

2. Who is not a Consumer ?

A person is not a consumer if he/she:

- ✓ Purchases any goods or avails any service free of charge;
- ✓ Purchases a good or hires a service for commercial purpose;
- ✓ Avails any service under contract of service.

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